TRAINER ANSWER KEY

Lab 4 – AI-Assisted Ethics Investigation

Suggested observations for the trainer. These are indicators for discussion, not findings of misconduct.

Potential allegations

Possible areas to explore include preferential treatment, inappropriate sharing of competing bid information, possible conflict-of-interest concerns, and procurement-process irregularities. Phrase these as allegations or investigation questions.

Potential red flags

E1 may indicate possible sharing of competitor-rate information before a revised quote. E2 shows two POs of ■4.9 lakh each approved by PM-1. E3 combines both POs into one ■9.8 lakh invoice. E4 is a potential relationship indicator but does not prove a conflict. E5 shows CleanPro's price is higher than the other two bids.

Alternative explanations

The email wording may have an innocent explanation; the two POs may reflect legitimate separate requirements; the invoice may legitimately combine them; the phone-number match may have an unrelated explanation; CleanPro may have had a valid commercial or technical reason for a higher price.

Additional evidence to request

Procurement policy and approval thresholds; original bid submissions and timestamps; bidder communications; evaluation/scoring records; business justification for vendor selection; PO creation timestamps; invoice and service records; conflict disclosures; vendor due-diligence records; relevant payment information.

Timeline – supported dates

03 Feb 2026 – E1 email. 10 Feb 2026 – E3 invoice. 14 Feb 2026 – E2 POs. Dates for the vendor-master record and bid-sheet creation are not stated and should not be guessed.

Core teaching point

Copilot can organize evidence quickly, but the investigator must distinguish allegation → observation → red flag → verified finding. The exercise should not result in a conclusion of misconduct.